10. Honecker’s Paris Trip Nurtures Western Ties, LA Times . 9 January 1988.

11. ZPA IV 2/2039/64. Report of a conversation between Honecker and Medvedev, 24 August 1988.

12. ZDF History, ‘Honecker’s Secrets’.

13. When the Easter edition of the weekly newspaper ‘Die Kirche’ appeared – huge white blank spaces denoted the areas cut by censors.

14. Die Welt. 9 June 1988.

15. Sputnik , published since 1967, appeared as a monthly magazine in seven languages with a total circulation of around one million copies. The German edition sold around 130,000 of these by subscription and around 60,000 in individual sales. The magazine, based on Reader’s Digest, with selected articles from Soviet newspapers and magazines, enjoyed great popularity because of its colourful mix of travel reports, cooking recipes, crossword puzzles and cultural articles. Since the mid-1980s, Sputnik has also provided first-hand information about the two pillars of Gorbachev’s reform policy – perestroika and glasnost.

16. When Stalin branded the Social Democrats ‘social fascists’, the KPD, which was subject to Moscow guidance, was unable to enter an alliance with them.

17. East Germany Launches Censorship Drive Against Soviet Reforms. 8 December 1988

18. This was confirmed by the Central Committee Secretary and Politburo member Joachim Herrmann. Neues Deutschland . 27 January 1990

19. ‘Hidden Hand’. Geoffrey Gedmin. AEI (1992) p.61

20. Mitteilung der Pressestelle des Ministeriums für Post – und Fernmeldewesen der DDR [Sputnik-Verbot]. 19 November 1988.

21. Parteisäuberungen und Widerstand in der SED. (1996). p.91